

The Employee Handbook

FY 2026–27

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MESSAGE FROM CEO'S DESK

Welcome to Spark Eighteen!

You're not just joining a company - you're becoming part of an organisation that's built on ambition, ownership, and the belief that small, driven teams can create outsized impact.

At Spark Eighteen, we operate with a simple philosophy: build with intent, move with speed, and take pride in what we ship. Whether we are working with global startups or building our own products, the expectation remains the same - think like an owner, act with integrity, and continuously raise the bar.

This handbook is not just a set of policies. It reflects how we work, how we collaborate, and how we grow together. It's designed to give you clarity, not constraints - so you can focus on doing your best work.

We believe in people who take initiative, stay curious, and support each other. You'll find a culture that values accountability, openness, and a bias toward action.

As you begin your journey here, I encourage you to immerse yourself, ask questions, and take ownership early. The more you put in, the more you will grow - both personally and professionally.

We're excited to have you with us. Let's build something meaningful together.

Aayush Narang

Founder / CEO, Spark Eighteen

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. About SP18

We are an IT outsourcing company specialized in product development and technical consulting. Our team expertise in web, mobile and infrastructure development. Let's work as a team and turn your idea into a product.

1.2. SP18 Services

We provide world class services which include ApplicationDevelopment, API Development, Data Engineering, New Tech, UI/UX Design, Digital Marketing, DevOps, CTO as a Service and Build your Team.

1.3. Company Mission

SP18's mission is to create an ecosystem to enable and help employees to grow, keep learning and deliver world-class solutions to customers. All while maintaining an impeccable culture that breeds happiness and joy.

1.4. Policies and Procedures

The aim of these policies and procedures (that is 'this Document') is to describe SP18's working practices. These are expected to promote consistency and transparency and thus create an environment of trust and motivation. Various items in this document relate, primarily, to administrative aspects. They also describe various directive principles as well as facilities available to the employees.

Another objective of this document is to enumerate general terms of employment and conditions of service for all employees of the Company, ensuring equal treatment for all. Deliberate failure in following these guidelines can be a sufficient ground for disciplinary action, including dismissal.

1.5. Values

SP18 is an Employee Centric organization and all our core values revolve around keeping our employees first.

1. Integrity
2. Mutual growth and respect
3. Fostering an environment of learning and sharing
4. Passion for Innovation
5. Equality

1.6. Benefits

1.6.1. Monetary Benefits:

1.6.1.1. Provident Fund - SP18 practices the PF Scheme, 1946 as applicable by Government of India. The scheme helps all the employees in loans, free insurance, lifelong pension scheme entitlement, income tax exemption and partial fund withdrawals.

1.6.1.2. Annual Bonus - At SP18, we value the dedication and contributions of our employees and recognize their efforts through an Annual Bonus. This bonus is a token of appreciation for consistent performance and commitment throughout the year.

1.6.1.2.1. Eligibility for the Annual Bonus is based on the following criteria:

1.6.1.2.1.1. The employee must have completed a minimum of one financial year with SP18.

1.6.1.2.1.2. Employees who leave the company in between the financial year will not be eligible for the bonus.

1.6.1.2.2. The bonus will range from 0% to 3% of the annual gross salary.

1.6.1.2.3. The final payout will be determined on the company's overall financial performance.

1.6.1.3. *Weekend Work Incentives* - SP18 provides monetary compensation for working extra time on weekends/public holidays as per the client's requirement and leads approval.

1.6.1.4. *Relocation Allowances* - SP18 covers transfer expenses and other similar expenses incurred by an employee who relocates to the office location.

1.6.1.5. *Referral Bonus* - SP18 acknowledges when an employee refers someone for an open position with a referral bonus.

1.6.1.6. *Retention Bonus* - SP18 provides retention bonus to its employees upon reaching milestones.

1.6.1.7. *Learning and Development Fund* - SP18 promotes continuous learning by supporting employee upskilling in evolving and emerging technologies.

1.6.2. Fringe Benefits:

1.6.2.1. *Health Insurance* - SP18 provides health insurance to all the employees. This insurance would take care of the hospitalization coverage including pre and post hospitalization expenses.

- 1.6.2.2. *Paid Maternity & Paternity, Bereavement and Marriage Leaves*** - With these paid leaves, SP18 believes in supporting the employees through thick and thin and understands that they need some time off when becoming a new parent, when someone very close in the family passes away and while entering a new phase in their life by getting married.
- 1.6.2.3. *Employee Development*** - SP18 supports continuous learning through programs, training, and certifications that enhance employee capabilities and contribute to organizational growth.
- 1.6.2.4. *Flexible Working Hours*** - The company offers flexible working hours to its employees based on the nature of the projects they are assigned to. Employees who have meetings or calls scheduled outside of regular office hours, or during morning hours, may adjust their office arrival and departure times, provided that the following conditions are met:
- 1.6.2.4.1.** Productivity remains unaffected.
 - 1.6.2.4.2.** Team Engagement is maintained.
 - 1.6.2.4.3.** Team Availability is ensured.
 - 1.6.2.4.4.** Team/Client Meetings are attended as required.
 - 1.6.2.4.5.** Must not be under the influence of alcohol or drugs during these hours.
 - 1.6.2.4.6.** If any of the above factors are found to be compromised, the employee can be removed from the project, after the first formal notice from the HR. In the event of repeated violations, the organization reserves the right to initiate

separation proceedings, which may result in termination of employment.

- 1.6.2.4.7. Employees are expected to be present in the office if requested by their respective Project Managers. However, Project Managers cannot make such requests on a continuous basis.
- 1.6.2.4.8. Employees who are not allocated to any project, as well as members of non-technical teams, shall follow standard office working hours.
- 1.6.2.4.9. In exceptional cases, non-project employees who wish to change their work hours may seek approval by discussing with the Operations Head.
- 1.6.2.5. *Remote Working* - Remote working arrangement in SP18 helps the employees to work from any location other than the SP18 offices.
- 1.6.2.6. *Work From Home* - WFH is a flexibility given to the SP18 employees for maintaining work-life balance.
- 1.6.2.7. *Company Retreat* - We believe that work and fun go hand in hand. To create a positive and engaging work environment, we regularly organize fun and team-building activities to help employees relax, connect, and unwind from work.
- 1.6.2.8. *Welcome Kits* - To make the new joiner more comfortable with the workplace, SP18 welcomes them with some goodies.
- 1.6.2.9. *Fun Gifts & Celebration* - SP18 celebrates festivals, achievements, and occasions etc. The company believes in

making the special occasions of the employees more special by celebrating them just like a family by giving appropriate gifts to the employees pertaining to the occasion.

2. BUSINESS AND PERSONAL CONDUCT

2.1. Guidelines

SP18 expects ethical and proper behavior from all employees at all times. An exhaustive list of unethical practices cannot be provided. Instead, SP18 relies on the judgment of each individual employee to avoid such practices. No employee should take unfair advantage of anyone, including SP18's partners, clients, vendors, and interns, through manipulation, concealment, abuse of privileged information, misrepresentation of material facts, or any other unfair dealing practice.

2.2. Code of Ethics and Business Conduct

Integrity is one of SP18's core values. The Code of Ethics and Business Conduct for employees defines our minimum set of ethical standards for all to ensure compliance with applicable laws and to uphold the reputation of the Institution for integrity and professional conduct.

2.3. Conflicts of Interest

As an employee of SP18, it is imperative that you avoid conflicts of interest. A conflict of interest arises when an employee takes action or enters into relationships that oppose the interests of SP18 or that interfere with the employee's performance or independent judgment when carrying out his or her duties. You may not exploit your position or relationship with SP18 for personal gain. Not all conflicts of interest will be prohibited. Each case will be decided on an individual basis.

For example, there is likely conflict of interest if you:

- 2.3.1. Use non-public SP18 clients or vendor information for the personal gain of you, your relatives or your friends.
- 2.3.2. Receive any payments or gifts, other than gifts of nominal value, from any third party as a result of your position with SP18.
- 2.3.3. Serve in any capacity in any institution that competes with SP18 there are other situations in which a conflict of interest may arise.

2.4. Adherence to Information Technology (IT) and Information Security (IS)

As an employee of SP18, it is required to understand, acknowledge, and comply with the organization's IT and Information Security Policies and Procedures from the first day of access. This includes safeguarding company assets, maintaining confidentiality, and adhering to approved usage standards. Employees are accountable for protecting systems, data, and credentials, and for promptly reporting any suspected security incidents or policy violations.

Key expectations include:

- 2.4.1. Use only authorized systems, applications, and devices for business purposes
- 2.4.2. Maintain strong password hygiene and never share credentials
- 2.4.3. Handle sensitive and personal data in accordance with classification and privacy requirements
- 2.4.4. Avoid unauthorized software installation, data transfers, or external sharing
- 2.4.5. Immediately report phishing attempts, suspicious activities, or security incidents
- 2.4.6. Comply with access control, remote work, and acceptable use policies at all times

All employees are expected to go through all the IT and IS Policies rolled out at the organization level and accessible to all employees. Once the same is done, you shall be signing an Acceptable Use Declaration under Acceptable Use Policy.

Failure to adhere to any of the policy requirements or safeguarding controls/expectations may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination, in line with company policy.

Please refer to the detailed policy available on the Policy Shared Drive ([click here to access](#)).

2.5. Substance Abuse

SP18 is committed to providing a safe workplace for our employees. Substance abuse threatens the safety of our employees and those with whom we come in contact, as well as the quality of our work. Therefore, the company prohibits the manufacture, possession, use, sale, or transfer of illegal drugs and substances on company's property or at any place during working hours. Nor does SP18 tolerate the use of illegal drugs or other substances by an employee outside of work when that use affects an employee's conduct or work performance.

SP18 employees are not to be under the influence of illegal drugs on Institution property or at any place during working hours. Any employee reasonably believed to be in violation of this policy will be subject to immediate discipline, up to and including termination of employment. This does not apply to physician-prescribed or physician recommended drugs provided they do not affect job performance or safety. If SP18 has reason to believe that violations of the law are occurring on company property, it may ask a law enforcement agency to investigate.

2.6. Alcohol Use During Working and Work-Related Hours

SP18 has a responsibility to maintain a safe work environment for its employees:

Employees must not be under the influence of alcohol or drugs during working hours, irrespective of whether they are working in-office, remotely, or during flexible or extended hours.

Alcohol may not be served at meetings, events or in-house celebrations.

Alcohol may not be consumed on the office premises. Any person who violates this policy will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment services.

2.7. Personal Safety

Your work sometimes may require that you stay late at the workplace. We value your personal safety and it is important that you follow these guidelines to ensure that your personal safety is not compromised.

- 2.7.1. Women employees shall not stay alone after official work hours.
- 2.7.2. Please ensure you leave premises after office hours.
- 2.7.3. Transport home when you work late will be organized upon prior intimation.
- 2.7.4. In the event that there is a need to stay late you are requested to inform your manager and Admin so that appropriate arrangements can be made.

2.8. Physical Safety

Accidents can be prevented only with your cooperation. In establishing the following safety practices, our primary objective is to keep our employees safe and free from injury. We ask your cooperation in observing the following:

- 2.8.1. If you are not certain whether a person has the authority to enter a SP18 facility, talk to them to determine their reason in the office.

- 2.8.2. Immediately report every work-related accident, injury, or potentially hazardous condition, no matter how minor, report them to your manager or HR
- 2.8.3. SP18 shall not be responsible for any loss of or damage to employees' personal belongings or vehicles. Employees are advised to take due care and ensure the safety of their personal property, including items such as purses, watches, mobile phones, and tablets, at all times.
- 2.8.4. If you see any unusual or questionable incidents, report them to your manager or HR.

2.9. Protecting Proprietary Information

Information about SP18's work, technology, financial information, and general working plans are confidential assets of the Institution until declared to be open public documents. It is important that you do not divulge any of this information to volunteers or any other persons except on a need-to-know basis and only with protection of a legally binding non-disclosure agreement, signed by a member of the senior management team.

Volunteer and employee information such as names, salary or level increases, personal records, and telephone and email directories must be kept confidential. Refer outside requests for such information to the HR Department. As a general rule, SP18 will not release any volunteer or employee information without the specific written approval of the volunteer or the employee.

Reference checks: Employees are advised to direct all calls for references on former employees to the HR Department. We will only release dates of engagement and positions held with SP18. Any other recommendations must be approved by the HR Department.

2.10. Contact with the Media

It is SP18's policy that no employee should communicate with the media unless this communication has been approved in advance by the HR. Please refer all media inquiries

to HR. Additionally, the employees will not represent SP18 in SP18-related discussions/ chat rooms and/or bulletin boards without prior approval of Program coordinators or senior management.

2.11. Dealing with Visitors

Non-official visitors including friends, former employees and volunteers must be met outside the office and not brought into the work area. Family members may be brought in for a brief period, if required.

2.12. Loss or damage of SP18 Property

Every employee is responsible for property such as laptops, tablets, mobiles, data cards, projectors, cameras, books etc. of SP18 that they avail to support their program or activity. Loss or damage of these items will need to be borne by the employee.

In the event of loss or theft of SP18 assets attributable to negligence (e.g., leaving a laptop unattended in a public place, personal vehicle, or parking facility), the employee is required to immediately notify their supervisor and the SP18 IT/Information Security team. The employee must also ensure that a formal police report (FIR or equivalent, as applicable by jurisdiction) is promptly filed and a copy submitted to the organization for record and further incident management.

In the event that an employee's laptop experiences hardware damage, it should be taken to an authorized Apple service center for diagnosis and determination of the cause.

2.12.1. Examination Fee:

The company will cover the initial examination fee of ₹2500 charged by the Apple Service Center.

2.12.2. Assessment of Damages:

2.12.2.1. Employees must take their devices to the nearest Apple Service Center for evaluation.

2.12.2.2. A detailed report should specify whether the damages are due to individual negligence (e.g., screen or physical harm, water spillage) or software-related issues.

2.12.3. Cost Sharing for First-Time Damages:

2.12.3.1. For the first occurrence of screen damage or any other damage caused by individual negligence, repair costs will be shared equally (50:50) between the company and the employee after diagnosis.

2.12.3.2. The company will bear the repair costs if the issue is software-related and not due to negligence.

2.12.4. Subsequent Damages:

2.12.4.1. Any additional negligence-related damages after the first occurrence will be fully borne by the employee.

2.12.4.2. In the event of outstanding dues during notice period/termination, this would be recovered in the Full and Final Settlement.

2.13. Solicitation and Distribution

From time to time, SP18 may be approached by external individuals or organizations seeking to solicit, sell, or distribute merchandise, services, or literature to employees on company premises. While we aim to maintain a respectful and consistent approach, such activities are not permitted in order to ensure the integrity, security, and smooth functioning of the workplace.

SP18 does not permit solicitation or distribution, by SP18 employees or third parties, during work time or on SP18 premises. Employees may not use any of SP18's electronic communication media to solicit or advertise outside products or services, political donations or contributions. Generally, solicitations or advertisements for charitable organizations may not be made without the prior approval of senior management or the HR Department.

2.14. Software Purchase Policy

It is the policy of SP18 that the copyright laws will be obeyed in all instances. The practice of illegally using or copying software will not be condoned, officially or unofficially. It is your responsibility as a SP18 employee to make sure you are in compliance with all laws and legal agreements relating to the use of computer software. You should make sure that you could document the legality of each software package on any workstation assigned to you. The unauthorized duplication, operation on machines other than for which licensed, or other “piracy” is a violation of the law and may expose you and the Institution to legal processes. Hence it is mandatory that all installations and downloads should be routed to the Technology department. Violations will cause disciplinary action to be taken.

2.15. Email Security Policy

E-mail is one of SP18’s core internal and external communication methods. The purpose of this policy is to ensure that e-mail systems are used by the employees to support institution functions to their fullest capacity. This policy advises employees of their responsibilities and provides guidance in managing information communicated by email.

Please refer to the detailed policy available on the Policy Shared Drive ([click here to access](#)).

2.15.1. Use of Email

E-mail services, like other means of communication, are to be used to support SP18 requirements. Employees may use e-mail to communicate informally with others in the SP18 so long as the communication meets professional standards of conduct. Employees may use e-mail to communicate outside of the SP18 when such communications are related to legitimate SP18 activities and are within their job assignments or responsibilities. Employees should not use e-mail for illegal, disruptive, unethical or unprofessional activities, or for personal gain. SP18 email ids are the property of the organization. It is recommended that you refrain from utilizing this id for personal use.

2.15.2. Privacy and Access

An employee member is prohibited from accessing another user's email without his or her permission. Accessing the main SP18 emails, other than your personal SP18 email, is to be done post consultation with your Director.

2.15.3. Security

E-mail security is a joint responsibility of the Technology Team and e-mail users. Users must take all reasonable precautions, including safeguarding and changing passwords, to prevent the use of the account by unauthorized individuals. System administrators will monitor messages as necessary to assure efficient performance and appropriate use. Messages or attachments relating to or in support of illegal activities will be reported to the appropriate authorities.

2.15.4. Do's and Don'ts (Applicable to all e-mail messages and attachments):

- 2.15.4.1. Take all reasonable precautions, including safeguarding and changing passwords, to prevent the use of the account by unauthorized individuals.
- 2.15.4.2. It is advisable to use a password of minimum 8 characters with at least 1 numeric or special character in between.
- 2.15.4.3. Be courteous and follow accepted standards of etiquette.
- 2.15.4.4. Protect others' privacy and confidentiality.
- 2.15.4.5. Consider organizational access before sending, filing, or destroying e-mail messages.
- 2.15.4.6. Protect the user ID and passwords.
- 2.15.4.7. Should open or execute email attachments only after virus scanning.

- 2.15.4.8. Not send unsolicited email messages, including the sending of "junk mail" or other advertising material to individuals who did not specifically request such material (email Spam). Care should be taken when sending mails to broadcast addresses like group mail lists.
- 2.15.4.9. Creating and/or forwarding chain letters.
- 2.15.4.10. Not send any email or attachments, which may contain information that is privileged, confidential or exempt from disclosure under applicable law.
- 2.15.4.11. Not send any emails or attachments threatening, obscene or harassing others.
- 2.15.4.12. Not use the SP18 email services for private advertising of products or services or for personal use.
- 2.15.4.13. It is advisable to use FTP if the attachment size is very large.

2.15.5. Internet Usage Policy

SP18 provides access to the vast information resources of the Internet and Local Area Network [LAN]. The facilities to provide employees and persons legitimately affiliated with SP18 for the efficient exchange of information and that access represents a considerable commitment of SP18's resources for telecommunications, networking, software, storage, etc. This Internet and Computer usage policy has been designed to help you understand our expectations for the use of those resources in the particular conditions of the Internet and to help you use those resources wisely.

2.15.6. Use and Conduct:

- 2.15.6.1. Internet access and other computer resources are working tools, provided to you at significant cost. That means we expect you to

use your Internet and network access primarily for work-related purposes, i.e., to communicate with clients, work related partners, to research relevant topics and obtain useful information except as outlined below.

- 2.15.6.2. Employees may use their Internet facilities for non-business research or browsing as long as it does not interfere with the employee's ability to do his or her job and provided that all other usage policies are adhered to.
- 2.15.6.3. We insist that you conduct yourself honestly and appropriately on the Internet, and respect the copyrights, software licensing rules, property rights, privacy and prerogatives of others, just as you would in any other dealings. To be absolutely clear on this point, all existing Institution policies apply to your conduct on the Internet, especially (but not exclusively) those that deal with intellectual property protection, privacy, misuse of Institution resources, sexual harassment, information and data security, and confidentiality.
- 2.15.6.4. Each employee using the Internet facilities of the Institution shall identify himself or herself honestly, accurately and completely (including one's Institution affiliation and function where requested) when participating in chats or newsgroups, or when setting up accounts on outside computer systems.
- 2.15.6.5. Unnecessary or unauthorized Internet usage causes network and server congestion. It slows other users, takes away from work time, consumes supplies, and ties up printers and other shared resources. Unlawful Internet usage may also garner

negative publicity for the Institution and expose the firm to significant legal liabilities.

- 2.15.6.6. Users should refrain from using the Internet for any personal use and work on personal projects during the working hours, which is between 10 A.M. and 7 P.M.

Please refer to the detailed policy available on the Policy Shared Drive ([click here to access](#)).

3. PROBATION POLICY

3.1. Policy Purpose

The company will make an effort to ensure that its hiring procedures serve the purpose of recruiting the best employees for each open position. However, we acknowledge that they are inevitably not always accurate in predicting performance or determining appropriate cultural fit. The Probationary Period provides an opportunity for the company, supervisor and employee to assess the employment relationship. The Probationary Period allows supervisors to oversee an employee's work, offer advice to increase effectiveness, or dismiss the employee. The probation period for new employees gives both employee and employer enough time to find out if their employment relation will eventually work out to the benefit of both.

3.2. Guidelines

- 3.2.1. The duration of the probation period would be 3 months and it could be confirmed/extended/dismissed based on the discretion of the management.
- 3.2.2. As part of the onboarding process, probationary employees may be required to work from the office for approximately one week. This may

be considered as one of the factors while evaluating the confirmation or extension of the probation period. The requirement will depend on the team the employee is assigned to and may vary on a case-by-case basis.

- 3.2.3. During the probation period, employees will receive regular monthly feedback and guidance from their mentor/supervisor to support their learning, performance, and overall development in the role.
- 3.2.4. At the end of the probation period (or earlier, based on performance), a review meeting may be conducted. During this meeting, the mentor/supervisor, in consultation with HR, will evaluate the employee's performance to determine whether the employment should be confirmed, the probation period extended (up to a maximum of three months), or the employment discontinued. This decision will be based on an assessment of the following criteria:
 - 3.2.4.1. The skills, competencies and knowledge of the employee on the job.
 - 3.2.4.2. The employee's progress on given assignments.
 - 3.2.4.3. The reliability, trustworthiness and other relevant personality characteristics of the employee.
 - 3.2.4.4. The employee's relations and collaboration with subordinates, supervisors and peers.
- 3.2.5. The above mentioned criteria will be assessed with quantitative measures if applicable. The progress will be documented wherever possible.

- 3.2.6. SP18 can terminate the employment during or end of the probation by giving a notice period of 15 days whereas new employees can terminate the same by serving 30 days of notice period.
- 3.2.7. Only Sick and Bereavement Leaves can be availed during the probation period. All the other policy benefits are applicable after successful completion of the probation period. In special cases, the decision of the management would be final.

4. INTERNSHIP POLICY

4.1. Policy Purpose

SP18 provides internships to the students which play a crucial role in shaping their career. It not only helps undergraduates and graduates gain real exposure to working environments but also helps them develop the necessary skills required to stand out in a job market. SP18 facilitates training to both technical and non-technical students.

4.2. Guidelines

- 4.2.1. The duration of the internship period would be 6 months for technical graduates and 3 months for non-technical graduates. It could be confirmed/extended/dismissed based on the discretion of the management.
- 4.2.2. During the internship period, the intern would be given consistent feedback and training by the mentor/ supervisor to have the chance to learn, gain practical experience while working on small projects.
- 4.2.3. At the end of the internship period (or possibly before that), there would be a meeting wherein the mentor/ supervisor with the help of HR will determine if the intern should be confirmed, terminated, or the

internship period should be extended maximum up-to 3 months. This decision will be based on an assessment of the following criteria:

- 4.2.3.1. The intern's skills, competencies, and knowledge relevant to the role.
- 4.2.3.2. The intern's progress on given assignments.
- 4.2.3.3. Their reliability, trustworthiness and other relevant personality characteristics of the intern.
- 4.2.3.4. The intern's relations and collaboration with subordinates, supervisors and peers.
- 4.2.4. The above mentioned criteria would be assessed with quantitative measures if applicable. Their progress will be documented wherever possible.
- 4.2.5. SP18 can terminate the employment during the internship period by giving a notice of 15 days whereas an intern can terminate the same by serving 30 days of notice.
- 4.2.6. Technical interns are eligible to take Restricted Holiday Leave after 3 months of internship period.
- 4.2.7. During the internship period, only Sick Leave and Bereavement Leave may be availed. All other policy benefits will become applicable upon successful completion of the internship. In exceptional cases, any deviations will be subject to the discretion and final decision of the management.

5. REFERRAL POLICY

The purpose of the employee referral policy is to reward the recruitment efforts of the employees to bring in new talent to the company. We place great importance on referrals because we trust our employees know what's best for our company. We want to make this process as smooth as possible for our employees and those who they refer to.

5.1. Eligibility criteria for referring

- 5.1.1. All employees are encouraged to participate in the referral program.
- 5.1.2. The following individuals are not eligible for referral bonuses:
 - 5.1.2.1. Members of the Management Team
 - 5.1.2.2. Employees at Lead level and above
 - 5.1.2.3. Members of the People Operations team
- 5.1.3. If a candidate who has accepted an offer from SP18 provides a referral, they will be eligible for the referral bonus only after both the referrer and the referred candidate have successfully completed their probation and have been confirmed as SP18 employees. At the time of payout, both individuals must be active employees of SP18.
- 5.1.4. If the referred candidate joins SP18 but the referrer does not join, no referral bonus will be payable.
- 5.1.5. The referred candidate must successfully complete the probation period and be confirmed for the referral bonus to be applicable.
- 5.1.6. If the referred candidate has applied directly through the company website or is in the HR database in the last 6 months, then the employee who referred will not be eligible for the referral bonus.

5.1.6.1. If the referred candidate is an ex- employee of SP18, then the employee who referred will not be eligible for the referral bonus.

5.1.6.2. If two or more employees refer to the same candidate, only the first referrer will be eligible for the referral bonus.

5.2. Job openings in the company

5.2.1. All the current open positions are listed on the careers section of our website.

5.2.2. All the internship positions are also listed on the careers section of our website.

5.2.3. In cases where a position is not listed on the company website, employees may still refer candidates, and such referrals will be eligible for a referral bonus, subject to policy terms.

5.3. Employee referral bonus amount

An employee who successfully refers someone for the current open position shall receive the referral bonus amount, as per the table shown below:

Years of experience (of the referred candidate)	Referral Bonus Amount(Technical)	Referral Bonus Amount (Non-Technical)
8 years & above	Rs. 1,00,000	Rs. 50,000
5 to 8 years	Rs. 75,000	Rs. 40,000

3 to 5 years	Rs. 50,000	Rs. 20,000
1 to 3 years	Rs. 25,000	Rs. 10,000

Both the referrer and the referred employee must be active employees of SP18 at the time of referral bonus payout.

If the employee who referred is on leave of absence/long leaves/maternity, then the payment would be made once the employee resumes to work.

All the bonuses would be subject to taxation, as applicable.

5.4. Process

In order to refer, the employee should submit the referred candidate's CV along with the referral form (link below) and then can have a discussion with the Recruitment Team.

When the referred candidate is offered and accepts the post, the Recruitment Team would notify the concerned employee.

Referrers are eligible for bonuses if a candidate is hired at a later time (but not later than 6 months) or even gets hired for another position.

[Link for the employee referral form](#)

Note:- The company reserves the right to modify the referral bonus policy from time to time. Certain rewards may be revised or withdrawn if deemed ineffective or inefficient. Any such changes will be communicated clearly and in a timely manner.

6. EMPLOYEE RETENTION POLICY

The purpose of Employee Retention Bonus Policy is to recognize and reward employees for their long-term commitment, loyalty, and sustained contribution to the organization. By incentivizing tenure, the company aims to foster employee satisfaction, encourage continued service, and reduce attrition rates among key team members.

6.1. Eligibility Criteria

- 6.1.1. All full-time employees who have completed the specified years of continuous service with the company are eligible.
- 6.1.2. The service duration is counted from the date of joining as a confirmed employee.
- 6.1.3. There should be no major disciplinary actions or performance improvement plans in the employee's record in the 12 months preceding the eligibility.
- 6.1.4. The employee must be actively employed with the company at the time of the bonus disbursement.
- 6.1.5. Should not have been on prolonged leave during the applicable years. Final decisions regarding what constitutes prolonged leave and its impact on eligibility will be at the discretion of the management.

6.2. Milestone-Based Retention Bonus

The retention bonus will be awarded upon completion of the following milestones:

Years of Continuous Service	Bonus Amount
10 Years	₹2,00,000

15 Years	₹5,00,000
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6.3. Process for Disbursement

- 6.3.1. The retention bonus will be processed following the milestone completion.
- 6.3.2. The bonus is subject to applicable tax deductions as per prevailing laws.

6.4. Exceptions and Final Authority

- 6.4.1. Any exception to the policy must be approved by the HR in consultation with the Senior Management.
- 6.4.2. The company reserves the right to amend, suspend, or terminate this policy at its discretion.

7. EMPLOYEE LEAVE POLICY

This policy ensures that all team members have a clear path to requesting time off while maintaining our commitments to clients and internal project timelines.

7.1. Guidelines for Applying Leaves

- 7.1.1. Approval Authority & Workflow: The approval path is determined by your current deployment status.
 - 7.1.1.1. Project-Deployed (Client Facing): You must email the Client directly for approval, ensuring your Project Manager and leaves@sparkeighteen.com is in CC.

7.1.1.2. Shadow Roles or Non-Client Facing: Approval must be obtained from your assigned Project Manager(s) with leaves@sparkeighteen.com in CC.

7.1.1.3. Non-Deployed: Approval must be obtained from your respective Tech Lead with leaves@sparkeighteen.com in CC.

7.1.2. Mandatory Consent & Communication

7.1.2.1. Authorization: No leave is considered "Approved" without explicit written consent through mail from the designated approver.

7.1.2.2. Follow-up Protocol: If you do not receive a response, you are required to send a follow-up email once every 24 hours for up to two consecutive days.

7.1.2.3. Management SLA: Project Managers and Leads are expected to provide a decision on leave requests within one (1) working day.

7.1.3. Sick, Emergency, & Bereavement Leave

7.1.3.1. Immediate Reporting: If you are physically unable to email (e.g., medical emergency), you must notify the HR Team via a phone call or Slack.

7.1.3.2. Medical Documentation: For any sick leave exceeding two (2) consecutive days, a valid medical certificate must be submitted to leaves@sparkeighteen.com.

7.1.3.3. Emergency Overrides: In cases of bereavement or medical emergencies, HR has the authority to grant leave approval without prior email consent from project or tech leads.

7.1.4. To allow for proper resource planning, the following leave intimation periods are mandatory:

7.1.4.1. Standard Leave (>2 Days): Any planned leave exceeding two days requires a minimum of 20 days' prior notice. Failure to adhere to this may result in the request being denied, depending on the approver's discretion.

7.1.4.2. Extended Absences (Combined WFH + Leave): If your total time away from the office (Work From Home combined with Leave) exceeds three (3) consecutive days, you must provide at least 7 days' prior intimation. The Project Manager/Tech Lead holds the ultimate authority to approve or deny these requests based on project needs.

7.1.5. Updating your leaves on HR Portal:

7.1.5.1. All kinds of leave(s) requests must first be approved via email and subsequently submitted through the HR Portal, at least one week in advance (depending on the nature of the leave).

7.1.5.2. Apply all leaves in the HR Portal by 28th of the month to ensure accurate payroll and attendance records.

7.1.6. Unapproved absences or failure to follow the leave guidelines may result in the leave being categorized as Loss of Pay (LOP).

7.2. Half-Day Leave

7.2.1. Half-day leave may be availed by employees working from the Udaipur office, subject to a minimum of four working hours being completed to constitute a half day.

- 7.2.2. Employees working from the Delhi office or in remote roles are not eligible for half-day leave.

7.3. Working Days and Schedule

- 7.3.1. The Company observes a five-day work week from Monday to Friday.
- 7.3.2. The last Saturday of each month may be designated as a working day for team-building activities, learning sessions, and management-led open houses. This is subject to change based on the operational requirements and business needs of the Company. Please note that such working days will not be considered as weekend work.

7.4. Earned Leave

- 7.4.1. The entitlement of earned leave shall be 12 days for each completed year of service.
- 7.4.2. Earned Leave can be accumulated up to a maximum of 20 days. However, only a maximum of 2 days can be carried forward every year. No accumulation beyond 20 days will be permitted under any circumstances.
- 7.4.3. Earned Leave is granted subject to work exigencies. However, the Project/Tech Lead holds the right to disapprove the EL request.
- 7.4.4. Earned leaves cannot be availed during the first three months of probation. However, in a medical emergency or in special cases, the management may take a call on it. It is strictly case to case basis.
- 7.4.5. While serving notice period earned leaves cannot be availed, however at the discretion of the management it could be considered.
- 7.4.6. Calculation of Earned Leave entitlement:

7.4.6.1. Earned leaves will not accrue on any period of absence or leave on loss of pay or reduced pay.

7.4.6.2. At the commencement of each calendar year, HR Portal will be updated with the earned leaves

7.4.7. Encashment of Earned Leave

Employees with more than 2 earned leaves are eligible to encash up to 10 excess leaves at the end of each calendar year, as per encashment policy. The encashment will be calculated based on the basic pay.

Example:

If an employee has 5 leaves at the end of the year, 2 leaves will be carried forward to the next year, and 3 leaves will be eligible for encashment.

If an employee's total monthly gross salary is ₹60,000, the monthly basic salary shall be ₹30,000. The leave encashment calculation will be as follows:

Basic salary per day: $\text{₹}30,000 \div 30 = \text{₹}1,000$

Encashment for 3 days: $\text{₹}1,000 \times 3 = \text{₹}3,000$

7.5. Sick / Casual Leave

7.5.1. Sick leaves can also be availed as casual leaves, after the completion of probation period.

7.5.2. The entitlement of Sick/Casual Leave shall be 3 days per fiscal year on full pay.

7.5.3. This Leave cannot be accumulated and encashed, therefore will lapse if not used by the end of the fiscal year.

7.5.4. Sick/Casual Leaves are applied to all employees excluding notice period employees.

- 7.5.5. In special circumstances, management may grant additional Sick Leave(s), especially in genuine cases of chronic illnesses certified by a registered medical practitioner.

7.6. Restricted Holiday Leave

- 7.6.1. Every SP18 employee can take 3 restricted holiday leaves each year. Refer to the holiday calendar to know about the restricted holidays.
- 7.6.2. Restricted Holiday Leave cannot be accumulated and encashed, therefore will lapse if not used by the end of the fiscal year.
- 7.6.3. Half day Restricted Holiday will also be considered as a full day Restricted Holiday.
- 7.6.4. Restricted Holiday leave cannot be availed by employees on probation period and notice period.

7.7. Special Leave

- 7.7.1. Employees are entitled for 1 special leave in a year to celebrate their birthday.
- 7.7.2. Half day Special Leave will also be considered as a full day Special Leave.
- 7.7.3. Special Day Leave cannot be availed during probation and notice period.
- 7.7.4. Special Day Leave cannot be accumulated and encashed, therefore will lapse if not used by the end of the fiscal year.

7.8. Maternity Leave

To allow better comprehension and clarity on Maternity Leave for Women employees. Our company maternity & paternity leave policy outlines the company's provisions for employees who are expecting a child and/or require time to care and bond with their newborn. The company endorses the right of its employees to become parents. For women, we are also aware that pregnancy or caring for an infant or a newly adopted child may cause difficulties for them in relation to their job duties. We are, therefore, prepared to support pregnant employees and expecting fathers and allow new mothers enough time to recover from childbirth and care for their child and new fathers to support the family and care for their child.

7.8.1. Statutory Maternity Leave:

- 7.8.1.1. Maternity leave shall be governed by the Maternity Benefit Act.
- 7.8.1.2. The employee must have completed at least 80 days of service in the 12 months immediately preceding the expected date of delivery.
- 7.8.1.3. A maximum of 26 weeks of maternity leave shall be granted to eligible employees.
- 7.8.1.4. Employees may avail maternity leave up to a maximum of 8 weeks prior to the expected date of delivery.
- 7.8.1.5. During the maternity leave period, the employee shall be paid a salary equivalent to the pay drawn immediately prior to commencement of leave. For employees covered under ESIC, maternity benefits shall be processed in accordance with ESIC provisions.

- 7.8.1.6. Maternity leave shall not be debited from the employee's leave balance.
- 7.8.1.7. Intervening weekly offs, national holidays, declared holidays, and festival holidays shall be counted as part of maternity leave.
- 7.8.1.8. Any extension of leave beyond the prescribed period due to postnatal complications shall be subject to management approval.
- 7.8.1.9. Discussion regarding the plan of Maternity Leave needs to be done beforehand with the Project Leads (approval from all the Project Leads, in case of multiple projects) & Tech Lead. Then after, the approval of the same should be taken through email (cc: HR). All the Leads are expected to respond to the email request within 1 working day.
- 7.8.1.10. A female employee who legally adopts a child under the age of three months is entitled to 12 weeks of paid adoption leave, effective from the date the child is handed over to the adoptive mother.
- 7.8.1.11. In the event of a miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, a female employee is entitled to 6 weeks of paid leave immediately following the incident, subject to the submission of a valid medical certificate.
- 7.8.1.12. Before availing this leave, a certificate from the Physician has to be submitted mentioning the expected date of delivery.
- 7.8.1.13. In case of leave taken due to illness, case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner has to be obtained and submitted

to the HR department. Medical termination of the pregnancy should be one that is advised by the doctor/medical practitioner. Benefits will not apply if it is a voluntary termination. In case of voluntary termination, leave cannot be claimed under the maternity leave policy.

7.8.1.14. Maternity leave shall be applicable for the first two deliveries only.

7.8.1.15. Maternity leave shall not be encashable.

7.8.2. Maternity Leave Extension:

7.8.2.1. If, because of any complication, leave has to be extended, it can be done as Loss of Pay.

7.8.2.2. Employees who have completed one year in the organization and are confirmed employees will be eligible for a Maternity Leave extension up to a maximum of 3 months. This would be unpaid leave and can be availed post completion of the statutory Maternity Leave. Employees would also be eligible to request for an extension, with part time work from home. This would be for a maximum period of 3 months on half day and commensurate half pay. This may be taken upon completion of the statutory Maternity Leave.

7.8.2.3. The organization reserves the right to find temporary replacement for the position held by the employee in the event a long absence of the employee is impacting the work of the organization.

7.8.2.4. The management would review all requests for extension of Maternity Leave, prior to approval.

7.8.2.5. Further extension requests over and above the stated policy on Maternity Leave Extensions would need to be put up to the management on a case-to-case basis.

7.8.3. Condition:

7.8.3.1. To avail maternity benefits within 7 months of joining, a woman employee must disclose at the time of joining that she is pregnant. Otherwise the company is not obliged to protect pay during maternity leave.

7.8.3.2. A woman employee who has availed Maternity Leave with full pay shall forfeit her claim to such pay, if she works in any other establishment during her Maternity Leave.

7.9. Paternity Leave

7.9.1. A male member of the organization with fewer than two surviving children may be granted paternity leave for a maximum period of 12 calendar days.

7.9.2. An employee shall be eligible to avail Paternity Leave upon completing at least 80 calendar days of continuous service with the Company prior to the expected date of delivery.

7.9.3. The paternity leave can be taken up to 10 days prior to the delivery of the child, or within 6 months from the date of delivery or legal adoption of the child. This will be paid leave and may be combined with any other leave.

7.9.4. Discussion regarding the plan of Paternity Leave needs to be done beforehand with the Project Manager(s). Thereafter, approval should be taken through email (cc: HR). All Managers are expected to respond to the email request within 1 working day.

- 7.9.5. Paternity leave cannot be accumulated and encashed; it will lapse if not availed within the stipulated 6-month period from the date of delivery/adoption.
- 7.9.6. Sundays, weekly off days, and holidays may be prefixed or suffixed to Paternity Leave.

7.10. Bereavement Leave

- 7.10.1. The company understands that the employees need time-off from work to grieve, attend a funeral or other related personal matters in case of death of an immediate family member. This policy establishes rules and procedures regarding the bereavement leave entitlements of the employees.
- 7.10.2. All employees, except notice period employees, are eligible to apply for bereavement leaves.
- 7.10.3. In this policy, we define immediate family as spouse, parents, siblings, children, grandparents (maternal and paternal), and in-laws of the same types are also included.
- 7.10.4. Employees are entitled to a maximum of 3 days of bereavement leave in a fiscal year.
- 7.10.5. The Bereavement leaves must be availed within 15 days of the death of the family member. This cannot be accumulated and encashed.
- 7.10.6. This benefit can be availed only once per occurrence; it cannot be split across different time periods or financial years for the same event.
- 7.10.7. Bereavement leave is not cumulative, therefore, the unused days can not be carried forward to the next fiscal year.

7.11. Marriage Leave

- 7.11.1. SP18 recognizes that getting married is a very exciting time and provides Marriage Leave so you can have some additional time to cherish your wedding.
- 7.11.2. All employees are entitled to 5 days of Marriage Leave. Employees in probation period, and serving notice period are not eligible for this benefit.
- 7.11.3. Discussion regarding the plan of Marriage Leave needs to be done beforehand with the Project Lead(s) (approval from all the Project Leads, in case of multiple projects) & Tech Lead. Then after, the approval of the same should be taken through email (cc: HR). All the Leads are expected to respond to the email request within 1 working day.
- 7.11.4. All the Marriage leaves must be availed before or during 15 days of your marriage. This cannot be accumulated and encashed, therefore will lapse if not used by the end of the fiscal year.
- 7.11.5. Marriage Leave is applicable for the first legal marriage only and must be taken at the time of your marriage.
- 7.11.6. Documentary proof will be required in support of the leave request.
- 7.11.7. To avail these leaves, discussion with the HR is required regarding your marriage leave plans and should be applied a month in advance.

7.12. Personal Emergency Leave

- 7.12.1. Under normal circumstances no such leave is permissible.

- 7.12.2. However, to help employees attend personal emergencies of a totally unavoidable nature, the management may consider granting some days of authorized absence from work, entirely at its discretion.
- 7.12.3. Emergency Leave is not a matter of right and will be sanctioned subject to work exigencies.
- 7.12.4. The Earned Leave accrued will be taken into account and in case there is no earned leave then the same shall be treated as leave without pay.

7.13. Absenteeism

Any absence must be discussed with HR in advance. In emergency situations, please have someone call the office and inform. Any unauthorized absence beyond 3 days, may lead to disciplinary action.

8. WEEKEND WORK INCENTIVE

- 8.1. Weekend work shall be permitted only in cases where there is a specific requirement from the client. Such arrangements must be communicated in advance by the Project Manager, along with the necessary client approval, via email to the Operations Head, with HR marked in CC. Admin must also be included in such communications in cases where the employee is required to work from the office during the weekend. All such requests must align with business requirements.
- 8.2. As per company policy, in the event that a Project Manager is unable to complete a project delivery on time and requires the team to work on a weekend to compensate for delays, it may impact the Project Manager's performance evaluation. A delay requiring weekend work may be considered an exception only once per quarter. However, the team will be eligible for

compensation for their additional work. The Project Manager will not be eligible for any compensation.

- 8.3. Employees who are required to work on weekends have the option to either be reimbursed or compensated with an additional leave day, in accordance with company policy.
- 8.4. Employees without a Project Manager must follow the same process, reporting directly to the Operations Head.
- 8.5. Project managers would be responsible for informing HR via Google Form ([Weekend/Holiday Work Extension Form](#)) regarding the concerned project team members' extended work on weekends or official holidays.
- 8.6. This form is to be submitted during the particular month before the last working day itself when the weekend is worked upon by the team member.
- 8.7. This extended work pay would be referred to as Incentive.
- 8.8. Incentives would be calculated on a monthly basis and would be equivalent to team member's per day salary.

9. WORK FROM HOME

9.1. Background

Our company values hard work, collaboration and teamwork, so we'd like you to work in the office each day. However, we also understand that time-to-time, our employees prefer to work from home for different reasons like parenting, medical emergencies and others.

9.2. Policy Elements

- 9.2.1. Employees working from home must not carry out work for anyone other than SP18 and shall not undertake non-work related activities during their working hours.
- 9.2.2. They must not be under the influence of alcohol or drugs during the working hours.
- 9.2.3. Reasons that could demand work from home include but are not limited to:
 - 9.2.3.1. Parenting
 - 9.2.3.2. Bad weather
 - 9.2.3.3. Emergencies
 - 9.2.3.4. Medical reasons
 - 9.2.3.5. Work-life balance
- 9.2.4. To ensure optimal performance during WFH, employees should;
 - 9.2.4.1. Choose a quiet and distraction-free workspace.
 - 9.2.4.2. Have a stable internet connection adequate for the job.
 - 9.2.4.3. Dedicate full attention to the work on hand during the work hours.
 - 9.2.4.4. Ensure work and break schedules complement other team members working on the same project and are duly informed to the team beforehand.
 - 9.2.4.5. Ensure productivity remains unaffected.
 - 9.2.4.6. Team/Client Meetings must be attended.

9.2.5. Employees shall liaise with their team about their patterns of work and meeting schedules and are responsible for keeping their team informed about the status of their work.

9.2.6. Employees must intimate their Work From Home (WFH) request through email. All WFH requests shall be deemed pre-approved, provided the email is sent before 10:00 a.m. and the request is applied for in the HR portal. In cases where these conditions are not met, approval shall be subject to the discretion of the respective Project Manager(s) for employees assigned to projects, or the Tech Leads for employees not currently assigned to any project.

- Project Manager(s)
- Tech Lead (cc)
- leaves@sparkeighteen.com

9.2.7. Code of conduct and all other respective employment policies apply to employees while working, irrespective of work location or schedule arrangement.

9.3. Guidelines for WFH

9.3.1. The employee shall not be subject to any restriction on the number of Work From Home (WFH) days that may be availed in a month and may utilize WFH from their available balance as required. However, employees are expected to utilize their WFH days judiciously and distribute them reasonably throughout the year, ensuring that project deliverables and required office presence are not adversely affected.

9.3.2. If an employee's total time away from the office (including WFH, with or without leave) exceeds three (3) consecutive days, the employee must provide at least ten (10) days' prior intimation by emailing their Project

Manager/Tech Lead and marking leaves@sparkeighteen.com in CC. The approval or rejection of such requests shall be at the sole discretion of the Project Manager/Tech Lead, based on project requirements and business needs.

- 9.3.3. The total number of WFH allotted to each employee as per their organizational hierarchy is as follows,
 - 9.3.3.1. Leads and above: 42 WFH days in a year
 - 9.3.3.2. Seniors: Level 1/ Level 2 employees: 30 WFH days in a year
 - 9.3.3.3. Junior & Mid-Level employees: 24 WFH days in a year
- 9.3.4. These WFH days in a year will not be carried forward to next year.
- 9.3.5. Half day WFH will also be considered as a full day WFH. However, the People and Operations team is eligible to apply for a half day WFH.
- 9.3.6. Female employees are entitled to one (1) extra Work From Home (WFH) day per month in the event of menstrual-related discomfort. This WFH day must be utilized within the respective month and cannot be carried forward to subsequent months. This WFH will not be deducted from their total WFH balance. This request must be mailed before 10:00 a.m. with the subject line “Request for Menstrual WFH”.
- 9.3.7. WFH is a flexibility given to the employees for maintaining work-life balance and should not be considered as a matter of right and team and business needs will be considered and employees can be called for important in-office meetings and events.
- 9.3.8. You are expected to utilize your WFH cautiously/ carefully, as no request for extra WFH would be entertained.

9.3.9. WFH exceptions shall be subject to the final approval of HR.

9.3.10. Roles that are not eligible for WFH are:

9.3.10.1. Interns

9.3.10.2. Employees who are working on a probation period

9.3.10.3. Contractual employees

9.3.10.4. Employees serving notice period

9.4. Compensation and Benefits

9.4.1. WFH arrangements don't affect employees' employment terms, and no specific working benefits are applicable for WFH.

9.4.2. The company will not be providing internet allowance for work from home employees.

9.5. Communication

WFH and Remote workers must be available on Slack, phone and email during core working hours and present for all mandatory meetings. In case of any temporary absence during the working hours it must be proactively communicated to the respective team members and project manager(s). If an employee working from home fails to attend client calls or scheduled meetings without prior approval, the absence will be recorded as leave for that day. The Project Manager must inform the management in such cases. If the absence is reported by the client, appropriate action will be taken against the Project Manager. Multiple offenses in this regard can lead to termination of your employment with SP18.

9.6. Company Equipment

The company will provide all employees with laptops and accessories. The equipment is to be used only by the employee and strictly for company projects.

We understand that you may want to use your own devices for work (phone, i-pad, etc.), other personal devices should enforce secure data management procedures (including passwords and encryption). For all the types of equipment, employees must follow the following:

- 9.6.1. Keep their equipment protected.
- 9.6.2. Store equipment in a safe and clean place when not in use.
- 9.6.3. Follow all data encryption, protection standards and settings.
- 9.6.4. Refrain from downloading suspicious, unauthorized and illegal software.

9.7. Security of Information

Employees are responsible for keeping documents, sensitive business data and other work-related materials confidential and secure in the home-office location adhering to all norms and clauses as per Non Disclosure Agreement.

10. REMOTE OR TELEWORKING POLICY

10.1. Background

This Policy serves as a guide to help all our employees to understand the expectations of remote working at SP18 and feel well-supported throughout their experience. This Policy will be updated and adapted in the coming months and years as we assess how it impacts the business and the employees. All the remote employees are responsible for understanding and adhering to this Policy.

10.2. Policy Elements

- 10.2.1. For this policy, 'remote' is defined as an employee working full-time from any location other than the SP18 offices.
- 10.2.2. Employees must not carry out work for anyone other than SP18 and shall not undertake non-work related activities during their working hours.
- 10.2.3. The employee must not be under the influence of alcohol or drugs during work hours.
- 10.2.4. To ensure optimal performance during remote work, employees should:
 - 10.2.4.1. Choose a quiet and distraction-free workspace
 - 10.2.4.2. Have a stable internet connection adequate for the job
 - 10.2.4.3. Dedicate full attention to the work on hand during the work hours
 - 10.2.4.4. Ensure work and break schedules complement other team members working on the same project.
- 10.2.5. Employees shall liaise with their team about their patterns of work and meeting schedules and are responsible for keeping their team informed about the status of their work.
- 10.2.6. Code of conduct and all other respective employment policies apply to all employees while working, irrespective of work location or schedule arrangement.
- 10.2.7. Remote employees are required to provide their residential address at the time of joining. Any subsequent change in address must be formally communicated to the HR Team via official email.

10.3. Guidelines for Remote Work

- 10.3.1. Before entering into any remote work arrangement, the employee and the HR will evaluate the suitability of such an arrangement, reviewing the following areas:
 - 10.3.1.1. The employee will discuss with the Project Manager, Tech lead and HR, the job responsibilities and determine if the job is appropriate for the remote work arrangement.
 - 10.3.1.2. HR will typically determine if a position is entirely remote at the very start of the recruiting process. That being said, we know that situations change, and we encourage any employee to discuss their specific needs and schedule with HR.
- 10.3.2. At all times, remote work will be subject to the continuing approval of Project Lead, Tech Lead & HR. The company reserves the right to withdraw remote work approval upon reasonable notice.
- 10.3.3. Remote employees may be required to visit SP18 offices on a quarterly basis, if called upon, or as and when required. They may also be required to travel to client locations (onsite) based on business requirements.
- 10.3.4. Roles that are not eligible for full-time remote work are:
 - 10.3.4.1. Interns
 - 10.3.4.2. Administrative employee
 - 10.3.4.3. Designers
 - 10.3.4.4. Roles that require access to files and other office equipment

10.4. Compensation and Benefits

- 10.4.1. Remote work arrangements don't affect employees' employment terms.
- 10.4.2. Travel, accommodation and daily allowances related to quarterly visits to SP18 offices or any other official visit will be as per reimbursement policy.

10.5. Communication

Remote workers must be available on Slack, phone and email during core working hours and present for all mandatory meetings. In case of any temporary absence during the working hours it must be proactively communicated to the respective team members and project manager(s). If an employee working remotely fails to attend client calls or scheduled meetings without prior approval, the absence will be recorded as leave for that day. The Project Manager must inform the management in such cases. If the absence is reported by the client, appropriate action will be taken against the Project Manager. Multiple offenses in this regard can lead to termination of your employment with SP18.

10.6. Company Equipment

- 10.6.1. The company will provide all employees with laptops and accessories. The equipment is to be used only by the employee and strictly for company projects.
- 10.6.2. We understand that you may want to use your own devices for work (phone, i-pad, etc.), other personal devices should enforce secure data management procedures (including passwords and encryption). For all the types of equipment, employees must follow the following:
 - 10.6.2.1. Keep their equipment protected.

- 10.6.2.2. Store equipment in a safe and clean place when not in use.
- 10.6.2.3. Follow all data encryption, protection standards and settings.
- 10.6.2.4. Refrain from downloading suspicious, unauthorized and illegal software.

10.7. Security of Information

Employees are responsible for keeping documents, sensitive business data and other work-related materials confidential and secure in the home-office location.

Please refer to the detailed policy available on the Policy Shared Drive ([click here to access](#)).

11. PROFESSIONAL SELF DEVELOPMENT

11.1. Introduction

SP18 recognises the contribution of professional development to the performance of the employees and the company. This policy provides benefits to all the employees for their professional development training.

Employees applying for professional development courses should be aware that the grant and continued provision, at all times, is at the discretion of the Learning & Development Committee (Ind@sparkeighteen.com).

11.2. Objectives

11.2.1. The application of this policy is intended to:

- 11.2.1.1. Equip individuals with the skills, knowledge and experience to fulfill the requirements of their current role.

- 11.2.1.2. Contribute fully towards the achievement of the company's vision.
- 11.2.1.3. Equip employees with the skills, knowledge and experience required for career progression.
- 11.2.1.4. Motivate and encourage employees pursuing professional qualifications.

11.3. Scope of Professional Development

11.3.1. Conference Sponsorship

The organization encourages continuous learning through professional conferences and events. To maintain operational balance and fair fund allocation, the following guidelines apply:

- 11.3.1.1. All company-sponsored conferences are curated by the L&D Committee, with event dates shared in advance via the Company Calendar. The L&D team will nominate participants based on relevance, merit and suitability.
- 11.3.1.2. Education & Upskilling Fund to cover the costs of approved conferences.
- 11.3.1.3. Eligibility Criteria:
 - 11.3.1.3.1. This benefit is available only to confirmed, full-time employees.
 - 11.3.1.3.2. Employees currently on probation, internships, or contractual terms are not eligible.
 - 11.3.1.3.3. Employees serving their notice period are not eligible.

11.3.1.4. Approval Workflow:

- 11.3.1.4.1. The L&D Committee will coordinate with Project Managers and Tech Leads to ensure that the participant's involvement aligns with project timelines and resource availability.
- 11.3.1.4.2. Upon confirmation, the L&D Committee will issue a formal invitation to the employee. The employee is then required to notify their Project Manager(s) and the HR & Admin Team (cc) via email and formally apply through the HRMS.

11.3.1.5. Reimbursement Process:

- 11.3.1.5.1. Expenses are reimbursed only after the successful completion of the event.
- 11.3.1.5.2. Claims must include the L&D approval letter and all original bills/invoices.
- 11.3.1.5.3. The employee must be active on the company payroll at the time the reimbursement is processed; employees who have resigned or are in their notice period at the time of payout are ineligible.
- 11.3.1.5.4. Requests must be submitted via HRMS with original receipts, attaching all the expenditure receipts. The company's GST details are mandatory when a reimbursement request is made.
- 11.3.1.5.5. The invoices submitted should be in the name of SP18 Pvt. Ltd.

- 11.3.1.6. The grant and continued provision of professional development benefits are at the sole discretion of the company and may be modified or withdrawn based on business requirements.

11.3.2. Education Sponsorship

SP18 maintains a centralized fund governed by the L&D Committee to support continuous employee growth. For the 2026-27 period, the fund will primarily prioritize AI-focused upskilling initiatives. Employees may utilize their allocated Education & Upskilling Fund to cover the cost.

11.3.2.1. Eligibility Criteria:

- 11.3.2.1.1. This benefit is available only to confirmed, full-time employees.
- 11.3.2.1.2. Employees currently on probation, internships, or contractual terms are not eligible.
- 11.3.2.1.3. Employees serving their notice period are not eligible.
- 11.3.2.1.4. Employees currently undergoing formal disciplinary procedures (e.g., Performance Improvement Plan) will not be considered.

11.3.2.2. Approval Workflow:

- 11.3.2.2.1. Discuss leave requirements (if required) with your Project Manager to ensure project timelines are not impacted.
- 11.3.2.2.2. Obtain formal approval from your Tech Lead.
- 11.3.2.2.3. Forward the approvals to the L&D Committee via email (Ind@sparkeighteen.com) for final validation, CC'ing the admin team.

- 11.3.2.2.4. Upon initial approval from the Lead, the L&D Committee shall review the request and hold the final authority to approve or reject the same, based on the relevance and specifics of the course.
- 11.3.2.2.5. For offline/in-person events (if it falls on a working day), the duration of the event will be treated as Earned Leave (EL). If the employee has an insufficient leave balance, it will be treated as Loss of Pay (LOP).
- 11.3.2.3. The fund covers tuition/course fees only. It can be used for single or multiple courses within the annual limit.
- 11.3.2.4. Costs such as accommodation, meals, travel, membership fees, books, graduation ceremonies, and incidental equipment are not covered.
- 11.3.2.5. Time off for study or exams will be treated as Earned Leave (EL) or Loss of Pay (LOP) based on the employee's available balance.
- 11.3.2.6. Academic Performance & Retakes:
 - 11.3.2.6.1. The company is not liable to pay for courses that are failed, withdrawn from, or left incomplete.
 - 11.3.2.6.2. Costs for examination re-sits or module retakes are generally not funded. Exceptions may be considered at the company's absolute discretion in the following year if the failure was due to circumstances beyond the employee's control.
- 11.3.2.7. Reimbursement Process:

- 11.3.2.7.1. Payments are made upon successful completion of the course, subject to the submission of original bills and the L&D approval letter.
- 11.3.2.7.2. If an employee separates from the company within one year of availing the amount, it must be repaid to the company on a pro-rata basis.
- 11.3.2.7.3. Requests must be submitted via HRMS with original receipts, attaching all the expenditure receipts. The company's GST details are mandatory when a reimbursement request is made.
- 11.3.2.7.4. The invoices submitted should be in the name of SP18 Pvt. Ltd.
- 11.3.2.7.5. The provision of this benefit remains at the sole discretion of the management and may be reviewed or withdrawn at any time.

12. REIMBURSEMENT POLICY

12.1. Introduction

This Policy outlines the specific and reasonable expenditures incurred by the employees exclusively for the Company's business.

12.2. Eligibility

- 12.2.1. This Policy applies to all the employees of the Company.
- 12.2.2. Contractual employees are not eligible for this Policy.

12.3. Reimbursable Expenditures

Reimbursement would be done upon submission of bills

12.3.1. Travel Expenditures (only in case of official trips and client site visits):

- 12.3.1.1. This Policy will cover all the expenditures related to traveling to and fro and daily commuting.
- 12.3.1.2. All reimbursements of travel would be done as mentioned in the Perks & Benefits policy. More details are as listed below:
 - 12.3.1.2.1. Car - Self paid and pre approved by Admin.
 - 12.3.1.2.2. Bus - Self paid and pre approved by Admin.
 - 12.3.1.2.3. Train - Self paid and pre approved by Admin.
 - 12.3.1.2.4. Air - **Booking would be done by Admin only when other modes of transportation are unavailable and the same would be done upon 30 days prior information.**
- 12.3.1.3. Daily commuting expenses will be reimbursed as per [Perks & Benefits policy](#).
- 12.3.1.4. Before undertaking any official trip, the concerned employee shall submit a request to Admin by email and such request would include all necessary information such as purpose, location, dates and duration, method of traveling, etc. Requests must be made 30 days before the start of travel.
- 12.3.1.5. The employees may utilize personal vehicles for official travel when other transportation is unavailable. Mileage will be reimbursed as per the Annexure B.
- 12.3.1.6. Cancellation of travel shall be duly informed to Admin at least three days before the traveling date and must have a valid reason.

- 12.3.1.7. If any company assets are lost or damaged while on tour, employees should inform the concerned authority immediately. The Company reserves the right to recover the cost of lost or damaged assets from the employee's salary.
- 12.3.2. Food Expenditures (only in case of official trips and client site visits):
 - 12.3.2.1. Daily food allowances would be paid as per [Perks & Benefits policy](#).
 - 12.3.2.2. If the employee is supposed to take the client for dinner/lunch, the Company will reimburse the amount on actuals. However, you must take email approval from Admin before any such event.
- 12.3.3. Accommodation Expenditures (only in case of official trips and client site visits):
 - 12.3.3.1. Accommodation would be provided by the company, if company is unable to do so, you can book the hotel after pre approval from admin and the same would be reimbursed as per [Perks & Benefits policy](#).
 - 12.3.3.2. Room upgrades are permitted if there is no additional cost to the Company.
- 12.3.4. Other Reimbursable Expenditures:
 - 12.3.4.1. Expenses incurred on professional self-development will be reimbursed as per the policy.
 - 12.3.4.2. Relocation Allowances will be provided by the company in the following cases:

- 12.3.4.2.1. For employees relocating to SP18 offices, the relocation benefit mentioned under the [Perks & Benefits policy](#) shall be applicable. The relocation allowance includes one-way reimbursement (one-time) from the employee's home location to the SP18 office location, along with stay and logistical expenses.
- 12.3.4.2.2. In the event the employee resigns from the company or relocates back within one year of the initial relocation, the reimbursed amount shall be recovered from the employee's salary on a pro-rata basis.
- 12.3.4.2.3. The relocation allowance may be availed only during the first month of relocation.

12.4. Non - Reimbursable Expenses

The Company generally reimburses the expenses incurred directly in connection with the business. The following are some of the non-reimbursable costs, and the list is not exhaustive:

- 12.4.1. Expenses for personal entertainment (such as dry cleaning, laundry, cigarettes, alcohol etc.).
- 12.4.2. Room services, magazines, newspapers or books for personal reading.
- 12.4.3. Fines or penalties from any law enforcement agencies of any kind.
- 12.4.4. Any extension of stay due to personal reasons are not counted as official travel.
- 12.4.5. Expenditures on companions unless it was necessary and approved by the Company.
- 12.4.6. The loss or theft of personal belongings of the employee.

- 12.4.7. Charges incurred because of failure to cancel hotel/train/air reservation in time.
- 12.4.8. Extra luggage in case of air travel unless the excess luggage is because of official materials.
- 12.4.9. Any accidents or other damages to the vehicle is not covered under this Policy, and the employees are advised to have full coverage insurance for their vehicle.

12.5. Employee Responsibilities

- 12.5.1. All the invoices submitted for reimbursement should be in the name of SP18 Pvt. Ltd. Company's **GSTIN number (07AAQCS9352L1ZI)** should be mentioned in the invoices.
- 12.5.2. The list provided under this Policy is by no means exhaustive; employees should always get approval from Admin before incurring any expenditure on behalf of the Company.
- 12.5.3. Whenever possible, avoid mixing up the personal and business expenditures. If unavoidable, the employees must submit a detailed break up of expenses.
- 12.5.4. In case of any doubt with business expenditure, always consult with Admin before spending on such expenditures.
- 12.5.5. If any employee spends on an unapproved thing, the Company has the full right to reject such reimbursement

12.6. Procedure for Reimbursement

- 12.6.1. Requests must be submitted via HR Portal with original receipts.

- 12.6.2. Invoices must be in the name of SP18 Pvt. Ltd. and include the company GST details.
- 12.6.3. Admin shall scrutinize the reimbursement request form and the other documents attached and make sure such application complies with this Policy and other applicable rules and regulations of the Company.
- 12.6.4. An employee must mention arrival, departure date and time, number of days spent in the outstation city in the reimbursement request form.
- 12.6.5. After approval, Admin will then submit to accounts for reimbursement.
- 12.6.6. The accounts department must settle all by the 25th of every month. Any reimbursement requests submitted after the 25th will be processed in the following month's cycle.
- 12.6.7. All expenses must be supported by actual/original bills and would be reimbursed as per the [Perks & Benefits policy](#).
- 12.6.8. Travel advance, if any, to be paid to the employee will be credited to the employee account.
- 12.6.9. Any travel advance not used by an employee on travel, such amount shall be returned to the accounts department with a confirmation email.

Annexure B

	International	TIER 1	TIER 2	TIER 3
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Cities	Outside India	Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Ahmedabad and Pune.	Agra, Ajmer, Aligarh, Amravati, Amritsar, Asansol, Aurangabad, Bareilly, Belgaum, Bhavnagar, Bhiwandi, Bhopal, Bhubaneswar, Bikaner, Bilaspur, Bokaro Steel City, Chandigarh, Coimbatore, Cuttack, Dehradun, Dhanbad, Bhilai, Durgapur, Erode, Faridabad, Firozabad, Ghaziabad, Gorakhpur, Gulbarga, Guntur, Gwalior, Gurugram, Guwahati, Hamirpur, Hubli–Dharwad, Indore, Jabalpur, Jaipur, Jalandhar, Jalgaon, Jammu, Jamnagar, Jamshedpur, Jhansi, Jodhpur, Kakinada, Kannur, Kanpur, Karnal, Kochi, Kolhapur, Kollam, Kozhikode, Kurnool, Ludhiana, Lucknow, Madurai, Malappuram, Mathura, Mangalore, Meerut, Moradabad, Mysore, Nagpur, Nanded, Nashik, Nellore, Noida, Patna, Puducherry, Purulia, Prayagraj, Raipur, Rajkot, Rajamahendravaram, Ranchi, Rourkela, Ratlam, Salem,	Udaipur and all other cities
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			Sangli, Shimla, Siliguri, Solapur, Srinagar, Surat, Thanjavur, Thiruvananthapuram, Thrissur, Tiruchirappalli, Tirunelveli, Tiruvannamalai, Ujjain, Vijayapura, Vadodara, Varanasi, Vasai-Virar City, Vijayawada, Visakhapatnam, Vellore, and Warangal	
Mileage	TBD	Rs.9/Km	Rs.9/Km	Rs.9/Km

TBD - To be discussed at the time of International travel.

13. PERKS AND BENEFITS POLICY

13.1. Purpose

This policy outlines the structured benefits framework available to employees, based on their hierarchical level in the organization. The purpose is to recognize performance, encourage engagement, and support employee well-being and growth. You may view the complete policy [here](#).

13.2. Scope

This policy is applicable to all confirmed employees of SP18 and is structured based on the employee classification system.

13.3. Floaters

We believe that recognizing consistent effort, innovation, and positive influence is crucial to fostering a motivated and high-performing work culture. Our Recognition-Based Floaters are

designed to celebrate individuals and teams who go beyond their core responsibilities to contribute meaningfully to the organization.

13.4. Exceptions and Revisions

Any exceptions to this policy must be formally routed through the Human Resources department and are subject to approval by the management. The management retains full discretion to determine eligibility for awards and to amend, modify, or update the policy as deemed necessary. This policy will be reviewed on an annual basis and may be revised in alignment with the organization's strategic objectives and budgetary considerations.

14. INTERIM LEADERSHIP & RESPONSIBILITIES

14.1. Purpose:

The purpose of this SOP is to define the procedure to be followed when a vertical does not have an assigned Lead. This ensures continuity in leadership responsibilities, team coordination, and operational efficiency during such periods.

14.2. Scope:

This SOP applies to all verticals across the organization that temporarily operate without a designated Lead. It outlines the responsibilities of the immediate senior who assumes interim leadership functions.

14.3. Responsibility:

The immediate senior within the vertical will assume the role and responsibilities of the Lead.

14.4. Procedure:

- 14.4.1. Identification of Interim Lead: In the absence of a designated Lead, the immediate senior-most employee (or as communicated by the management) within the vertical (based on designation or experience) will act as the interim Lead.
- 14.4.2. Responsibilities of the Interim Lead: The interim Lead will temporarily perform the following functions in alignment with the role of a vertical Lead:
 - 14.4.2.1. Team Engagement: Organize and coordinate team-building activities, including team dinners and other relevant events.
 - 14.4.2.2. Recruitment Collaboration: Participate in recruitment and hiring processes relevant to the vertical.
 - 14.4.2.3. Operational Coordination: Collaborate with cross-functional teams and management to ensure smooth workflow and communication.
 - 14.4.2.4. Reporting: Maintain regular communication with the management regarding team progress, challenges, and updates.
 - 14.4.2.5. Mentorship: To plan & provide guidance and mentorship to junior team members and interns when and where required.
- 14.4.3. Duration and Handover:
 - 14.4.3.1. The interim arrangement will remain in effect until a new Lead is officially appointed.
 - 14.4.3.2. Upon appointment of the new Lead, the interim Lead must ensure a smooth transition and provide necessary handover documentation or updates.

14.5. Compliance and Review

This SOP must be reviewed periodically by the HR Department to ensure effectiveness and relevance. Any deviations from this procedure must be documented and approved by the management.

15. MENTAL HEALTH AND WELLNESS POLICY

Mental health issues are any conditions that affect employees' state of mind. These conditions range from mild depression, stress and severe anxiety and may result in burnout and nervous breakdowns. Substance abuse may also perpetuate mental health issues. Mental health problems manifest in different ways. Some employees may suffer with unnoticeable physical side effects, while others may experience physical symptoms (e.g. increased blood pressure, lethargy and changes in eating habits).

SP18's Mental Health policy outlines provisions to prevent and address mental health issues among our employees. Mental health is just as important as physical health. Mental illness may be detrimental to a person, as it impacts happiness, productivity and collaboration.

With this policy, SP18 aims to support all employees and create a healthy and happy workplace.

15.1. Scope

This policy applies to all our employees.

15.2. Objectives

- 15.2.1. To improve the productivity of the business by providing better emotional support to employees after critical incidents.
- 15.2.2. To minimize the disability of employees by ensuring that mental health problems are recognized at early stages and effective treatment is available.

- 15.2.3. To create awareness and prevent discrimination around mental illness.
- 15.2.4. To build healthy relationships at work and minimize possible conflicts among employees.
- 15.2.5. To maintain a healthy environment where employees feel comfortable and safe.
- 15.2.6. To develop a culture of trust, support and mutual respect in the workplace.

15.3. Factors causing mental health issues

Employees may experience mental health issues for various reasons that an employer cannot control (e.g. hereditary, family conflicts, general health.) But, there are also work-related reasons for mental health problems, including:

- 15.3.1. Job insecurity
- 15.3.2. Excessive pressure
- 15.3.3. Work-life imbalance
- 15.3.4. Lack of appreciation
- 15.3.5. Hostile workplace conditions
- 15.3.6. Unsatisfactory job or workload
- 15.3.7. Unpleasant relationships with colleagues or managers

15.4. Measures taken by SP18

SP18 undertakes the following measures to address mental health related issues:

- 15.4.1. Benefit of Insurance during Hospitalization.
- 15.4.2. WFH to maintain work-life balance.
- 15.4.3. Mental Health Leave(s) - It is at the discretion of the management depending on the seriousness of the issue(s).

- 15.4.4. Professional Services - We are engaged with mental health professionals so employees may reach out to this professional when they are in need of counseling. Anything they share with the professional will remain strictly confidential. Employees can reach out to the professional at **+91 9783315663** at the time of need and kindly refer as SP18 employee for billing purposes.
- 15.4.5. Mental Health Awareness - Company would share facts, articles, videos and infographics about mental health.
- 15.4.6. Open Communication and Support - Company encourages open communication between employees and management. If employees have a work-related problem, they can speak openly to the management. Management and employees will search for a mutually satisfying solution together.
- 15.4.7. Employee Recognition and Development - Company practices programs like mentorship, learning & development to prevent issues related to mental health.

16. CONSENSUAL RELATIONSHIP AGREEMENT (CRA)

16.1. Scope

This policy applies to all employees of the organization, regardless of their rank, department, or location, including full-time, part-time, and contractual staff.

16.2. Purpose

We recognize that personal relationships may develop among employees. However, it is important to maintain a professional work environment for everyone. To ensure fairness, transparency, and the avoidance of conflicts of interest, the company requires employees to

follow these guidelines if they enter into or are already in a personal relationship with another employee.

16.3. Disclosure Requirement

If you are in or enter into a personal relationship with a colleague (e.g., romantic or intimate relationship), you must inform HR. This ensures transparency and allows the company to manage any potential conflicts of interest, particularly if one of the employees has a supervisory role over the other, or if the relationship could influence work performance or decisions.

16.4. Signing the Consensual Relationship Agreement (CRA)

Upon disclosure, both parties involved in the relationship will be required to sign a Consensual Relationship Agreement (CRA). This agreement outlines expectations, boundaries, and procedures to ensure that the relationship does not impact the professional work environment. It helps to protect both individuals and the organization by addressing potential issues such as favoritism, conflicts of interest, and maintaining professionalism in the workplace.

16.5. When to Inform HR and Sign the CRA

- 16.5.1. Before or as soon as the relationship begins: If you start a relationship with a colleague, inform HR and sign the CRA immediately.
- 16.5.2. If you are already in a relationship: If you are currently in a relationship with a colleague, you are required to disclose it to HR and sign the CRA as soon as possible.

16.6. Privacy and Confidentiality

All information regarding your personal relationship will be kept confidential and only shared with relevant parties on a need-to-know basis. This helps to maintain privacy while ensuring fairness in the workplace.

16.7. Non-Compliance

Failure to disclose a relationship or sign the CRA may result in disciplinary action, as it can lead to issues such as favoritism, conflicts of interest, or violations of company policies.

17. PREVENTION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT (POSH) – (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal)

17.1. Purpose

SP18 is committed to creating a safe work environment that is free from any form of sexual harassment and where all employees are treated with dignity and respect. SP18 is dedicated to maintaining an environment which is free from coercion and intimidation. This policy is in accordance with the provisions of “The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013”. While the policy covers all the key aspects of the Act, for any further clarification reference shall always be made to the Act and the provisions of the Act shall prevail.

17.2. Applicability

This policy is applicable to all those engaged with SP18 regardless of their position or contractual status: ie. Permanent employees, short term contracts, outsourced employees deployed at SP18 premises or work sites, interns.

In addition to the above, this Policy also extends to those who are not employees of the Company who may be affected in the course of any activity related to the work of the Company or carried out within the premises used for the execution of the Company's work or day-to-day operations.

17.3. Sexual Harassment

- 17.3.1. Sexual Harassment is any unwelcome verbal, visual, or physical conduct of a sexual nature that affects the working conditions or creates a hostile work environment.
- 17.3.2. The victim as well as the harasser may be a man or a woman.
- 17.3.3. Harassment can come from the same gender.
- 17.3.4. Forms of Sexual Harassment
 - 17.3.4.1. Verbal Demand or request for sexual favors
 - 17.3.4.2. Comments about a person's sex or private life
 - 17.3.4.3. Sexually colored remarks
 - 17.3.4.4. Playing sexually suggestive music in the workplace
 - 17.3.4.5. Graphic / Written
 - 17.3.4.6. Unsolicited forwarding of pornographic pictures through email, sms, mms, IM or other media
 - 17.3.4.7. Display of sexually suggestive objects, pictures, magazines, posters, cartoons in the work area
 - 17.3.4.8. Written / email / SMS communication that has sexual implications
 - 17.3.4.9. Graphic or inappropriate art / lettering on clothes
 - 17.3.4.10. Offensive gestures
 - 17.3.4.11. Touching in a sexual manner

17.3.4.12. Assault or coerced sexual acts

17.3.4.12.1. Behaviour that isolates or is discriminatory towards or excludes a person on the grounds of their gender or sexual orientation.

17.3.4.12.2. Demanding sexual favours in return for, or with the promise of favourable performance appraisals, promotions, sustained employment and provision of employment.

17.3.4.12.3. Demanding sexual favours

17.3.5. UNWELCOME is the key in defining sexual harassment. It is the impact and effect the behavior on the recipient that will define the behavior as sexual harassment.

17.3.6. Sexual harassment at the workplace is generally classified under following circumstances:

17.3.6.1. Implied or explicit promise of preferential treatment in employment.

17.3.6.2. The implied or explicit threat of detrimental treatment in employment.

17.3.6.3. The implied or explicit threat about the present or future employment status.

17.3.6.4. Interference with work or creating an intimidating or offensive or hostile work environment.

17.3.6.5. Humiliating treatment likely to affect the employee's health or safety.

17.4. Recognizing Harassment

17.4.1. The following questions will help you in identifying and recognizing harassment.

17.4.1.1. Did I consent to the behavior?

17.4.1.2. Does this behavior make me uncomfortable?

17.4.1.3. Does the behavior violate my dignity as an individual?

17.4.1.4. Does it violate to work in dignity in a safe working environment?

17.4.2. If the answer to question “a” is a ‘No’ and the answers to Questions “b”, “c” & “d” are a ‘Yes’, you are most probably in a harassment situation.

17.4.3. When you find out that the incident is Harassment;

17.4.3.1. Speak out, Speak up at the time of occurrence.

17.4.3.2. Keep records

17.4.3.3. Set your own boundaries

17.4.3.4. Be aware of situations and people who may harm you.

17.4.3.5. Trust your own instincts about possible unwelcome behavior / danger.

17.4.3.5.1. Tell someone

17.4.3.5.2. Create a witness to the behavior.

17.4.3.5.3. Report sexual harassment to the appropriate authority in the organisation.

17.5. Confidentiality

At all stages of the procedures-formal and informal, and from the first discussions when the potential allegations of sexual harassment are discussed, all parties to the discussion are required to be aware of the sensitivity of the matters under discussion, the potential impact of lives and careers and to exercise extreme caution in the disclosure of the information, and to maintain the confidentiality of the complainant and the person responsible for the behavior. While the policy is intended to provide protection to employees who make a Secured Disclosure, it is critical to note that if the committee determines that the complaint made is mala fide or a false documentation is provided, this would be subject to appropriate disciplinary action. A mere inability to substantiate a complaint or provide adequate proof will not necessarily lead to such disciplinary action. In case of any doubt before raising the complaint you may seek advice from the HR department or the Committee.

17.6. Incident Reporting

- 17.6.1. Employees who believe that he/she has been subject to sexual harassment should promptly inform the HR Department or the Sexual Harassment Committee.
- 17.6.2. The complaint will be made by submitting a written statement by the complainant. The complaint shall be raised within a period of 3 months from the date of the incident and in the case of a series of incidents within a period of 3 months from the last incident.
- 17.6.3. Where the Complainant is unable to make a complaint on account of her physical or mental incapacity or death or otherwise, their legal heir or such other person as may be prescribed may make a complaint.
- 17.6.4. The statement shall include the time, date and place of incident, description of the circumstances, names of the persons involved and witnesses present.

- 17.6.5. The employees shall have the right to file such complaints without the fear of reprisal or recrimination. The Sexual Harassment Committee shall be responsible to investigate and redress the alleged incident of sexual harassment.

17.7. Inquiry- Complaint Resolution

- 17.7.1. The Sexual Harassment Committee will take appropriate resolutions as per the act.
- 17.7.2. It shall investigate the complaint in a prompt and impartial manner by taking the following steps:
- 17.7.2.1. Once the complaint reaches the Committee, it will within 3 days respond to the complainant that the matter is being scrutinized and reviewed.
 - 17.7.2.2. Review the written complaint
 - 17.7.2.3. The Committee, may, before initiating Inquiry and at the request of the Complainant, take steps to settle the matter between the Complainant and the harasser through conciliation.
 - 17.7.2.4. Where a settlement has been arrived at, no further Inquiry shall be conducted by the Committee.
 - 17.7.2.5. To proceed with an inquiry the committee shall write an email to the harasser asking for his/her written statement and give one week's time to respond.
 - 17.7.2.6. Based on the response, investigate, include talking to the harasser, complainant and other relevant parties such as witnesses, HR department personnel, Managers and team members.
 - 17.7.2.7. Review any pertinent documents, evidence or records.
 - 17.7.2.8. In case witnesses are present, they will be asked to give their statement in writing.

- 17.7.2.9. Both parties shall be given an opportunity of being heard and a copy of the findings shall be made available to them to make a representation before the Internal Committee.
- 17.7.2.10. Prepare a written report regarding the findings and conclusions reached.
- 17.7.3. The report shall be furnished to the Management Committee for approval and then to the Head HR for taking appropriate steps to act on the complaint based on the recommendations of the Committee. This shall be done no later than 10 days post completion of the Inquiry.
- 17.7.4. The severity of the disciplinary action shall be determined by the severity and/or frequency of the offense. The complainant or the harasser shall be notified of the action(s) to be taken.
- 17.7.5. Evidence and records shall be filed and kept in safe custody by the HR Department.

18. WHISTLEBLOWER POLICY

18.1. Objective

This policy inculcates the culture of transparency between the management and employees and allows the employees to report to the management regarding any improper activities within the organization. SP18 believes in the policy of open communication and provides necessary safeguards for protection of employees from acts of victimization, for whistle blowing in good faith.

18.2. Harassment or Victimization

- 18.2.1. One is expected to cooperate in any internal or external investigations of possible violations. Reprisal, threats, retaliation against any person who has in good faith reported a violation or a suspected violation of

law, the code of conduct or other company policies, or against any person who is assisting in any investigation or process with respect to such a violation, are prohibited.

- 18.2.2. SP18 has a no tolerance policy against any act of harassment or victimization to the employee making a disclosure (hereinafter referred as whistleblower).

18.3. Confidentiality

The anonymity of the whistleblower will be maintained, subject to legal constraints.

18.4. Anonymous Reports

- 18.4.1. If the whistleblower reports the incidents in writing, he/she must put their names as they may be required for further investigations.
- 18.4.2. Reports received without names may not be investigated, unless the issue raised is of serious nature.

18.5. Spiteful Allegations

Spiteful allegations by employees may result in disciplinary action.

18.6. Complaint Procedure

- 18.6.1. SP18 strongly urges reporting all incidents of discrimination, harassment or retaliation, regardless of the offender's identity or position in the Company. Employees who believe that they may have witnessed or experienced discrimination, harassment or retaliation or violations of law, the code of conduct or other company policies or procedures should report complaints to the management of the Company before the conduct becomes severe.
- 18.6.2. In all cases, if the complainant is unsure about the appropriateness of an event or action, he/she should seek assistance in interpreting the requirements of these practices by contacting the Human Resources.

- 18.6.3. Depending on the seriousness of the complaint, the report will be investigated. If it is found that the report has no basis, or is caused due to misunderstanding, it may be dismissed at this stage.
- 18.6.4. If it is felt that further investigation is necessary, this will be carried through either by the authorized person alone or a committee would be formulated. The investigation would be conducted assuming neutral ground and would be held in an impartial manner. According to the report of the findings the committee (or authorized person) would recommend an appropriate course of action to the management. The investigation may include individual interviews with involved parties and, if necessary, investigation can also include employees who have observed the alleged conduct or have relevant information.
- 18.6.5. Confidentiality will be maintained throughout the investigation process.
- 18.6.6. Where an improper practice is proved, this would cover suggested disciplinary action, including dismissal, if applicable, as well as preventive measures for the future.
- 18.6.7. The amount of contact between the whistleblower and the body investigating the concern will depend on the nature of the issue and the clarity of information provided. Further information may be sought from him/her. Subject to legal constraints, s/he will receive information about the outcome of any investigations.
- 18.6.8. The whistleblower must present his case with appropriate proofs and facts.
- 18.6.9. Subjects will be informed formally about the allegations made against them and will be given fair chances to provide their relevant inputs.
- 18.6.10. The evidence presented to the Competent Authority during the entire course of investigation would not be withheld, destroyed or tampered and the subjects must ensure that they do not interfere with the process in any way possible.

- 18.6.11. The outcome would be disclosed within 45-60 days to both the subject and whistleblower.
- 18.6.12. All protected disclosures in writing or documented with the final outcome of the investigation shall be retained by the organization for a period of 2 years.

Please refer to the detailed policy available on the Policy Shared Drive ([click here to access](#)).

19. SEPARATION AND NOTICE PERIOD POLICY

19.1. Objective

The intent of this is to keep everyone informed on the responsibilities that lay on the individual as well the organization in separation scenarios.

19.2. Scope

Under this policy we cover all the provisions under which the employment of the employee with the company will be ceased.

19.3. Applicability

This policy applies to all employees.

19.4. Resignation Guidelines

- 19.4.1. Resignation is defined as a permanent separation from employment that is initiated by the employee.
- 19.4.2. When an employee decides to resign from SP18, they are required to give written notice to HR and the management through email mentioning their intention to leave or discontinue the service.

19.4.3. HR should interact with the resignee to understand the reason. Post this discussion, with mutual consent if,

19.4.3.1. The resignee chooses to stay back, withdraw the resignation in writing via email.

19.4.3.2. The resignee chooses to continue with the decision to resign, acknowledgement of the resignation email will be sent by the HR.

19.5. Notice Period

19.5.1. The minimum notice period is 3 months for all the employees.

19.5.2. There may be specifically identified contracts that will have Notice Periods defined exclusively in the letter of Appointment.

19.5.3. All employees are required to serve a full notice period or pay in lieu, the salary for the notice period not served.

19.5.4. Employees may raise requests to waive part/whole Notice Periods to the HR. The discretion to approve any waiver rests with the management.

19.5.5. Leave and WFH can not be availed during the Notice Period.

19.5.6. In exceptional cases involving medical or other exigencies, employees may be permitted to avail leave during their notice period subject to prior approval from HR and their reporting manager; in such instances, the company reserves the right to either extend the Last Working Day (LWD) by the equivalent number of days or treat the absence as Leave Without Pay (LWP).

19.6. Last Working Date

- 19.6.1. The last working date will be 3 months from the date of resignation email. In certain cases, it may be mutually decided by the management and the employee for early relieving.
- 19.6.2. If the last day of the notice period falls on a holiday or weekly-off, the employee shall be relieved on the working day prior to the holiday/ weekly off.

19.7. Termination of Employment Services

- 19.7.1. SP18 may terminate the services of any employee, if it is felt that the employee's continuance in the service is not in the interest of SP18. The power to terminate the services of any employee shall be exercised only by the management.
- 19.7.2. Incase of Violation of Code of Conduct/Policy on Prevention Sexual Harassment/Fraud, the company retains the right to terminate without any liability of providing Notice Period or Final Settlement.
- 19.7.3. The following process applies in cases of unsatisfactory performance: The organization follows a "Three-Strike" approach to address performance concerns. Each strike is documented via written feedback or performance notification sent over email.
 - 19.7.3.1. Strike 1: Initial Performance Notification

The first instance of unsatisfactory performance will result in a formal meeting and a written feedback email outlining the specific gaps and expectations.
 - 19.7.3.2. Strike 2: Second Performance Notification

If improvement is not sustained, a second written notification will be issued. This serves as a formal warning that continued underperformance will lead to a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).
 - 19.7.3.3. Strike 3: Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) & Notice Period

A third strike triggers a formal PIP. This period is designed to provide a final opportunity for the employee to meet the required standards. Crucially, the PIP period runs concurrently with the employee's notice period.

19.7.3.4. Final Evaluation & Separation

If the performance goals are successfully mitigated by the end of the PIP, the termination notice is rescinded, and employment continues. If the performance remains unsatisfactory at the end of the PIP, employment will be terminated immediately, as the notice period will have been served during the PIP.

19.7.4. As per company policy, in the event that an employee exhibits unprofessional behavior that disrupts workplace harmony or demonstrates a lack of respect towards colleagues, or fails to align with the company's work culture, SP18 reserves the right to issue a written notification of termination. This includes similar actions towards clients, where any behavior that undermines the company's relationship with clients or disrupts client interactions may result in termination.

19.7.5. The management of SP18 will determine whether to provide one month's notice or payment in lieu of notice upon termination of employment, based on the specific circumstances.

19.8. Handovers Before Relieving

19.8.1. It is expected that the separating employee shall complete his/ her work and commitments before the relieving date.

19.8.2. The Employee should also, prior to final settlement, hand over any returnable property of SP18 which includes laptops and accessories, keys/access cards, books, files etc.

- 19.8.3. The manager shall initiate the process of knowledge transfer and the newly joined (or) identified employee will take over charges & responsibilities from the outgoing employee.
- 19.8.4. The outgoing employee shall furnish all the information/documents relevant to the profile with the identified employee for a smooth functioning and continuity of process/job role.
- 19.8.5. It is expected that the separating employee must complete all the signing formalities and submit it to HR before being relieved.
- 19.8.6. On the closing hours of the last working day the employee's service and accounts come to cessation and stand relieved from his duties.

19.9. Full & Final Settlement

- 19.9.1. An "Exit Clearance Form" will be shared with all relevant departments, including Technical, HR, Admin, and Accounts. Each department is required to provide clearance and highlight any pending dues, handovers, or outstanding items.
- 19.9.2. Upon receipt of all clearances, the final settlement will be reviewed by the Accounts team, and the employee's salary and full and final settlement will be processed accordingly.
- 19.9.3. The Full and Final Settlement would be released as per the payroll calendar.
- 19.9.4. Mutual No Dues Certificate will be issued by the HR once all the settlement is cleared by both the parties.
- 19.9.5. The Relieving Letter, Experience Certificate will be issued only if the employee settles all dues of SP18.

19.10. Contact Information for Future Correspondence

Separating employees are required to provide their contact details and addresses for future correspondence, if need arises.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I acknowledge that I have received and read SP18's Employee Handbook and will adhere to the policies set forth in accordance with my employment agreement. I have had an opportunity to clarify any questions I may have about the content of the Policies and thoroughly understand them.

I understand that this is not a contract and is subject to change at any point of time at the sole discretion of SP18.

I agree to comply with all the below listed policies as part of my continued employment or association with SP18.

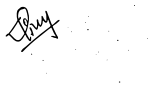
1. Introduction
2. Business and Personal Conduct Policy
3. Probation Policy
4. Internship Policy
5. Referral Policy
6. Employee Retention Bonus Policy
7. Employee Leave Policy
8. Weekend Work Incentive Policy
9. Work From Home Policy
10. Remote Or Teleworking Policy
11. Professional Self Development Policy
12. Reimbursement Policy
13. Perks & Benefits Policy
14. Interim Leadership and Responsibilities
15. Mental Health & Wellness Policy
16. CRA Policy
17. Prevention of Sexual Harassment Policy (POSH)
18. Whistleblower Policy
19. Separation and Notice Period Policy

Employee Name : Divya Bagora

Employee Id : E00327

Designation : Jr. Backend Enginner

Signature :



Date : 01-04-2026